

GRE Vocabulary Notes: Group 31

Group 31 Vocabulary

1. Abrogate

Meaning: To officially cancel or abolish a law, agreement, or practice.

Tip to remember: Abrogate sounds like “ab-rogate,” like breaking a legal gate open and removing the rule.

Sentence: The government decided to abrogate the outdated law.

2. Aghast

Meaning: Shocked, horrified, or filled with fear.

Tip to remember: Aghast sounds like “a ghost.” If you suddenly see a ghost, you feel aghast.

Sentence: The students were aghast when they saw the exam results.

3. Apprise

Meaning: To inform or notify someone.

Tip to remember: Apprise sounds like “appraise,” but apprise means inform. Think: “Please apprise me of updates.”

Sentence: The manager apprised the team of the new deadline.

4. Beguile

Meaning: To charm, deceive, or trick someone.

Tip to remember: Beguile sounds like “be guile.” Guile means clever trickery, so beguile means to trick with charm.

Sentence: The salesman beguiled customers with false promises.

5. Boon

Meaning: A benefit, blessing, or helpful thing.

Tip to remember: Think of a boon as a bonus. It is something good that helps you.

Sentence: Reliable internet is a boon for online learners.

6. Callous

Meaning: Emotionally hard; insensitive to others’ suffering.

Tip to remember: A callus is hard skin. A callous person has a hard heart.

Sentence: His callous remarks hurt the grieving family.

7. Coddle

Meaning: To treat someone too gently or protectively.

Tip to remember: Think of wrapping someone in cotton and protecting them from every small difficulty. That is coddling.

Sentence: Parents should support children but not coddle them too much.

8. **Crescendo**

Meaning: A gradual increase in loudness, intensity, or force.

Tip to remember: In music, crescendo means the sound grows louder. In GRE, any emotion or event can reach a crescendo.

Sentence: The protest reached a crescendo by evening.

9. **Extenuating**

Meaning: Making a fault or mistake seem less serious.

Tip to remember: Think of “extra explanation” that reduces blame. Extenuating circumstances lessen responsibility.

Sentence: The judge considered the student’s extenuating circumstances.

10. **Frenetic**

Meaning: Extremely energetic, fast, and uncontrolled.

Tip to remember: Frenetic sounds like “frantic.” Both suggest wild, rushed activity.

Sentence: The office became frenetic before the project deadline.

11. **Fringe**

Meaning: The outer edge; not mainstream or central.

Tip to remember: Think of the fringe of a cloth at the edge. Fringe ideas are also on the edge of common belief.

Sentence: The scientist rejected the fringe theory because it lacked evidence.

12. **Hapless**

Meaning: Unlucky or unfortunate.

Tip to remember: Hap means luck. Hapless means luckless.

Sentence: The hapless traveler lost both his ticket and passport.

13. **Immaculate**

Meaning: Perfectly clean, pure, or without flaws.

Tip to remember: Think of an immaculate white shirt with no stain at all.

Sentence: Her laboratory notebook was immaculate and well organized.

14. **Obfuscate**

Meaning: To make something unclear, confusing, or difficult to understand.

Tip to remember: Obfuscate sounds like “obscure.” Both involve hiding clarity.

Sentence: The politician used complex language to obfuscate the real issue.

15. **Ossify**

Meaning: To become rigid, fixed, or bone-like.

Tip to remember: “Os” relates to bone. Ossify means to become hard like bone.

Sentence: An organization can ossify if it refuses to accept new ideas.

16. **Pastiche**
Meaning: A work made by mixing styles or imitating other works.
Tip to remember: Think of a paste made from many ingredients. A pastiche combines many artistic styles.
Sentence: The film was a pastiche of old detective movies.
17. **Perspicacious**
Meaning: Having sharp insight and good judgment.
Tip to remember: Perspicacious sounds like “clear perspective.” A perspicacious person sees clearly.
Sentence: The perspicacious student quickly understood the flaw in the argument.
18. **Ponderous**
Meaning: Heavy, slow, dull, or awkward.
Tip to remember: Ponderous sounds like something you must “ponder” for too long because it is heavy and slow.
Sentence: The book’s ponderous style made it difficult to finish.
19. **Recluse**
Meaning: A person who lives alone and avoids other people.
Tip to remember: Recluse sounds like “re-close.” A recluse closes himself away from society.
Sentence: The writer became a recluse after becoming famous.
20. **Retaliate**
Meaning: To respond to an attack with a similar attack.
Tip to remember: Think of “return attack.” Retaliate means to attack back.
Sentence: The country warned that it would retaliate if attacked.
21. **Rhapsody**
Meaning: An enthusiastic expression of joy or praise; also, a musical work.
Tip to remember: Think of someone speaking with musical excitement and praise. That is a rhapsody.
Sentence: The critic wrote a rhapsody about the beauty of the film.
22. **Serendipitous**
Meaning: Happening by happy chance or luck.
Tip to remember: Think of accidentally finding exactly what you needed. That lucky discovery is serendipitous.
Sentence: Their serendipitous meeting led to a successful research collaboration.
23. **Shirk**
Meaning: To avoid or neglect a duty or responsibility.
Tip to remember: Shirk sounds like “shrink.” A person who shirks responsibility shrinks away from duty.
Sentence: He tried to shirk his responsibility during the group project.

24. **Sinecure**
Meaning: A job that gives pay or status but requires little or no work.
Tip to remember: Think of a comfortable job where someone gets salary without stress. That is a sinecure.
Sentence: The position was criticized as a political sinecure.
25. **Sinuous**
Meaning: Curving, winding, or full of turns.
Tip to remember: Sinuous sounds like snake-like. A snake moves in a winding, sinuous way.
Sentence: The sinuous road climbed through the hills.
26. **Sordid**
Meaning: Dirty, morally shameful, or unpleasant.
Tip to remember: Sordid sounds like “so dirty.” It can mean physically or morally dirty.
Sentence: The investigation revealed a sordid story of bribery.
27. **Stanch**
Meaning: To stop the flow of something, especially blood.
Tip to remember: Think of using cloth to stop bleeding. That action stanches the blood.
Sentence: The nurse tried to stanch the bleeding quickly.
28. **Surfeit**
Meaning: An excessive amount; too much of something.
Tip to remember: Surfeit sounds like “surplus fit.” It means more than fits or more than needed.
Sentence: The report had a surfeit of details and lacked focus.
29. **Ulterior**
Meaning: Hidden or beyond what is openly stated.
Tip to remember: Think of an ulterior motive hidden behind a friendly smile.
Sentence: He offered help, but she suspected an ulterior motive.
30. **Voluble**
Meaning: Speaking a lot and easily; talkative.
Tip to remember: Voluble sounds like “volume.” A voluble person has high volume of words.
Sentence: The voluble student answered every question in class.